

Chapter-11

Active and Passive Voice

Read the following pair of sentences carefully.

1. He reads a book.
2. A book is read by him.

The meaning of both sentences is the same. However, the structure is different. In Sentence 1, the subject of the verb 'reads' is 'He'. Here, the subject 'he' is the active doer of the verb/action. Hence, the sentence is in active voice.

In sentence 2, the subject of the verb 'is read' is 'A book'. Here, the subject is not the active doer of the verb/action. It is the passive receiver of the action. Hence, the sentence is in passive voice.

Active Voice: When the verb shows that the subject does something, it is said to be in Active Voice.

Passive Voice: When the verb shows that something is done to the subject, it is said to be in Passive Voice.

Now read the following examples carefully and observe how sentences are changed from active to passive voice.

Active Voice	Passive Voice
Boys are playing cricket.	Cricket is being played by boys.
Children made a noise.	A noise was made by children.
She teaches us maths.	We are taught maths by her.
This box contains sweets.	Sweets are contained in this box.
He knows me.	I am known to him.

The following steps are followed while converting a sentence from active to passive voice.

1. The object of the active verb is put in the place of subject.
2. The active verb is changed in passive form by using a form of 'be' according to tense of the active voice and the III form of the verb. Other auxiliaries are also used according to the tense.
3. The passive verb should be in agreement with the object which is brought forward.
4. The subject is kept after the passive verb and it is preceded by the preposition 'by', thus converting the subject into agent or doer.
5. In most of the cases preposition 'by' is used before agent. In certain cases preposition other than 'by' is used.

Important Rules to follow while changing the Active Voice into Passive Voice

1. Don't change the tense.
2. The passive voice of future continuous tense and all perfect continuous tenses is not possible.
3. Don't change the type of sentence.
4. Subject-verb agreement must be followed in passive voice too.

Change in Verbs from Active to Passive

Tense	Active Voice	Examples	Passive Voice	Examples
Simple Present Tense	S+V1+(s/es)+O S+does/do not + V1+O Does/do+S+V1+O Does/do+S+not+V1+O	He plays cricket. He does not play cricket. Does he play cricket? Does he not play cricket?	O+is/am/are + V3+by+S O+is/am/are+not+V3+by+S Is/am/are+O+V3+by+S Is/am/are+O+not+V3+by+S	Cricket is played by him. Cricket is not played by him. Is cricket played by him? Is cricket not played by him?
Simple Past Tense	S+V2+O S+did + not + V1+O Did+S+V1+O Did+S+not+V1+O	He played cricket. He did not play cricket. Did he play cricket? Did he not play cricket?	O+was/were+ V3+by+S O+was/were+not+V3+by+S Was/were+O+V3+by+S Was/were+O+not+V3+by+S	Cricket was played by him. Cricket was not played by him. Was cricket played by him? Was cricket not played by him?
Simple Future Tense	S+Will/shall+V1+O S+Will/shall+not+V1+O Will/shall+S+V1+O Will/shall+S+not+V1+O	He will play cricket. He will not play cricket. Will he play cricket? Will he not play cricket?	O+will/shall+be+ V3+by+S O+will/shall+ not + be + V3+by+S Will/shall+O+be+V3+by+S Will/shall+O+not+be+V3+by+S	Cricket will be played by him. Cricket will not be played by him. Will cricket be played by him? Will cricket not be played by him?
Present Continuous Tense	S+is/am/are +V1+ ing+O S+is/am/are+not+V1+ ing+O Is/am/are +S+V1+ ing+O Is/am/are+S+not+V1+ ing+O	He is playing cricket. He is not playing cricket. Is he playing cricket? Is he not playing cricket?	O+is/am/are+being+V3+by+S O+is/am/are+not+being+V3+by+S Is/am/are+O+being+V3+by+S Is/am/are+O+not+being+V3+by+S	Cricket is being played by him. Cricket is not being played by him. Is cricket being played by him? Is cricket not being played by him?
Past Continuous Tense	S+Was/were + V1+ing+O S+Was/were+not+V1+ing+O Was/were+S + V1+ing+O Was/were+S+not+V1+ing+O	He was playing cricket. He was not playing cricket. Was he playing cricket? Was he not playing cricket?	O+was/were+being+V3+by+S O+was/were+not+being+V3+by+S Was/were+O+being+V3+by+S Was/were+O+not+being+V3+by+S	Cricket was being played by him. Cricket was not being played by him. Was cricket being played by him? Was cricket not being played by him?
Present Perfect Tense	S+Has/have +V3+O S+Has/have +not +V3+O Has/have+S +V3+O Has/have+S +not +V3+O	He has played cricket. He has not played cricket. Has he played cricket? Has he not played cricket?	O+has/have+been+V3+by+S O+has/have+not+been+V3+by+S Has/have +O+ been+V3+by+S Has/have+O+not+been+V3+by+S	Cricket has been played by him. Cricket has not been played by him. Has cricket been played by him? Has cricket not been played by him?
Past Perfect Tense	S+Had+ V3+O S+Had+not + V3+O Had+S+V3+O Had+S+not + V3+O	He had played cricket. He had not played cricket. Had he played cricket? Had he not played cricket?	O+Had+been+V3+by+S O+Had+not+been+V3+by+S Had+O+been+V3+by+S Had+O+ not+been+V3+by+S	Cricket had been played by him. Cricket had not been played by him. Had cricket been played by him? Had cricket not been played by him?
Future Perfect Tense	S+Will/shall+have+V3+O S+Will/shall+not+have+V3+O Will/shall+S+have+V3+O Will/shall+S+not+have+V3+O	He will have played cricket. He will not have played cricket. Will he have played cricket? Will he not have played cricket?	O+Will/shall+have+been+V3+by+S O+Will/shall+not+have+been+V3+by+S Will/shall+O+have+been+V3+by+S Will/shall+O+not+have+been+V3+by+S	Cricket will have been played by him. Cricket will not have been played by him. Will cricket have been played by him? Will cricket not have been played by him?
Modal Auxiliary	S+Modal + V1+O S+Modal+not+V1+O Modal+S+V1+O Modal+S+not+V1+O	He can play cricket. He cannot play cricket. Can he play cricket? Can he not play cricket?	O+Modal +be+V3+by+S O+Modal +not+be+V3+by+S Modal+O +be+V3+by+S Modal +O+not+be+V3+by+S	Cricket can be played by him. Cricket cannot be played by him. Can cricket be played by him? Can cricket not be played by him?
Infinitive	S+V+to + V1+O	He wants to play cricket. He does not want to play cricket. Does he want to play cricket? Does he not want to play cricket?	S+V+O+to + be+V3	He wants cricket to be played. He does not want cricket to be played. Does he want cricket to be played? Does he not want cricket to be played?

1. Simple Present Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+V1+(s/es)+O He eats an apple.	O+ is/am/are + V3+by+S An apple is eaten by him.
Negative	S + does/do not +V1+O He does not eat an apple.	O + is/am/are + not + V3+by+S An apple is not eaten by him.
Interrogative	Does/do +S+ V1+O Does he eat an apple?	Is/am/are + O + V3+ by + S Is an apple eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Does/do +S+not+ V1+O Does he not eat an apple?	Is/am/are + O +not+ V3+ by + S Is an apple not eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

- Riya sings a song.
- Mohit flies a kite.
- He writes a letter.
- I like mangoes.
- He does not buy a book.
- They do not obey their father.
- Does your mother cook tasty food?
- Do the children paint pictures?
- Do you like me?
- Does Radhika not help the needy?

2. Simple Past Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+V2+O He ate an apple.	O+ was/were + V3+by+S An apple was eaten by him.
Negative	S + did not +V1+O He did not eat an apple.	O + was/were + not + V3+by+S An apple was not eaten by him.
Interrogative	Did +S+ V1+O Did he eat an apple?	Was/were + O + V3+ by + S Was an apple eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Did+S+not+ V1+O Did he not eat an apple?	Was/were + O +not+ V3+ by + S Was an apple not eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into Passive Voice.

- Richa sang a song.
- Children read their books.
- They built a new house.
- Did he open the window?.....
- She did not take coffee.

6. The boy did not welcome his friends.
7. Did she get any message?
8. Mina did not write letters.
9. Did you not buy any clothes?
10. The teacher did not correct my notebook.

3. Simple Future Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+will/shall+V1+O He will eat an apple.	O+ will/shall+be + V3+by+S An apple will be eaten by him.
Negative	S+ will/shall+ not +V1+O He will not eat an apple.	O+ will/shall + not + be+ V3+by+S An apple will not be eaten by him.
Interrogative	Will/shall+S+V1+O Will he eat an apple?	Will/shall+O+ be+V3+ by+ S Will an apple be eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Will/shall+S+not+V1+O Will he not eat an apple?	Will/shall+O+ not+be+V3+ by+ S Will an apple not be eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. Riya will tell a story.....
2. He will attend a party tomorrow.
3. The shopkeepers will close the shops at 9pm.
4. I will always obey my parents.
5. We shall say our prayers.
6. Will you not finish your work today?
7. Will they kill the snake?
8. She will not tell a lie.
9. Shall I help you?.....
10. Will the children not miss their school bus?

4. Present Continuous Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+ is/am/are+V1+ ing + O He is eating an apple.	O+ is/am/are + being + V3+by+S An apple is being eaten by him.
Negative	S+is/am/are+not+V1+ing+O He is not eating an apple.	O+is/am/are+ not + being+V3+by+S An apple is not being eaten by him.
Interrogative	Is/am/are+S+V1+ing+O Is he eating an apple?	Is/am/are+O+being+V3+ by+ S Is an apple being eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Is/am/are+S+not+V1+ing+O Is he not eating an apple?	Is/am/are+O+not+being+V3+ by+ S Is an apple not being eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. Girls are singing a song.
2. The carpenter is making a chair.
3. People are cutting trees in this forest.
4. My father is reading newspaper.
5. They are completing their work.
6. He is not plucking the flower.
7. Are you following me?
8. Is he flying a kite?
9. Are the workers not repairing the roads?
10. Am I troubling you?

5. Past Continuous Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+ was/were+V1+ ing + O He was eating an apple.	O+ was/were + being + V3+by+S An apple was being eaten by him.
Negative	S+was/were+not+V1+ing+O He was not eating an apple.	O+was/were+ not + being V3+by+S An apple was not being eaten by him.
Interrogative	Was/were+S+V1+ing+O Was he eating an apple?	Was/were+O+being+V3+ by+ S Was an apple being eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Was/were+S+not+V1+ing+O Was he not eating an apple?	Was/were+O+not+being+V3+ by+ S Was an apple not being eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. We were taking exercise.
2. Students were preparing their lessons.
3. He was not reading a book.
4. They were not killing tigers.
5. Were they stealing money?
6. Were the students revising their lessons?
7. Was I disturbing you?
8. The teacher was not scolding me.
9. Were you not taking lunch?
10. He was not avoiding me.

6. Present Perfect Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+has/have+V3+O He has eaten an apple.	O+ has/have + been+V3+by+S An apple has been eaten by him.
Negative	S+has/have+ not +V3+O He has not eaten an apple.	O+ has/have + not+ been + V3+by+S An apple has not been eaten by him.
Interrogative	Has/have +S+ V3+O Has he eaten an apple?	Has/have +O+ been+V3+ by+ S Has an apple been eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Has/have +S+not+ V3+O Has he not eaten an apple?	Has/have +O+not+ been+V3+ by+ S Has an apple not been eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

- I have cleaned my room.
- She has closed the windows.
- My mother has said her prayers.
- My father has not bought a new car.
- Students have not prepared presentations.
- Have you posted the letters?
- Has he painted a picture?
- Have your parents adopted this girl?
- Has the gardener watered the plants?
- Have you not broken the window?

7. Past Perfect Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+had+V3+O He had eaten an apple.	O+ had + been+V3+by+S An apple had been eaten by him.
Negative	S+had not +V3+O He had not eaten an apple.	O+had + not + been+V3+by+S An apple had not been eaten by him.
Interrogative	Had +S+ V3+O Had he eaten an apple?	Had +O+ been+V3+ by+ S Had an apple been eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Had +S+not+ V3+O Had he not eaten an apple?	Had +O+ not+ been+V3+ by+ S Had an apple not been eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

- The peon had rung the bell.
- He had not stolen my camera.
- He had seen some lions.
- They had covered their faces.
- Boys had visited the museum.

6. Had the team won the match?
7. The clerk had not checked the accounts.
8. Had she insulted you?
9. Had they not crossed the river?
10. They had not chosen their representative.

8. Future Perfect Tense

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+ will/shall+ have+V3+O He will have eaten an apple.	O+ will/shall+have+been+V3+by+S An apple will have been eaten by him.
Negative	S+ will/shall + not +have +V3+O He will not have eaten an apple.	O+will/shall+not+have+been+V3+by+S An apple will not have been eaten by him.
Interrogative	Will/shall+S+ have+V3+O Will he have eaten an apple?	Will/shall+O+have+been+V3+by+ S Will an apple have been eaten by him?
Interrogative Negative	Will/shall+S+not+ have+V3+O Will he not have eaten an apple?	Will/shall+O+not+have+been+V3+by+ S Will an apple not have been eaten by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. She will have kept her promise.
2. They will have won the scholarship.
3. He will have learnt English.
4. We shall not have wasted our time.
5. The teacher will not have punished these boys.
6. Will they have spoken the truth?
7. Rajan will not have solved the sums.
8. We shall have had our dinner.
9. Will you not have received the invitation?
10. Will they have dusted the carpet?

Changing Voice of Some Particular Categories with various Sentence Structures

Important note: While changing voice, the rules of tenses, subject-verb agreement and types of sentences, as explained previously, will remain the same.

9. Sentences with Modal Auxiliaries

Active: Subject+ can/could/may/might/should/ought to/must/used to/would+V1+Object

Passive: Object+ can/could/may/might/should/ought to/must/used to/would+ be+V3+by+Subject

Type of Sentence	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Affirmative	S+Modal+V1+O He can solve this sum.	O+ Modal +be + V3+by+S This sum can be solved by him.
Negative	S+ Modal+ not +V1+O He cannot solve this sum.	O+ Modal + not + be+ V3+by+S This sum cannot be solved him.
Interrogative	Modal+S+V1+O Can he solve this sum?	Modal+O+ be+V3+ by+ S Can this sum be solved by him?
Interrogative Negative	Modal+S+not+V1+O Can he not solve this sum?	Modal+O+not+ be+V3+ by+ S Can this sum not be solved by him?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. The rich should help the poor.
2. You can drive a car.
3. You must do your duty.
4. He may win the case.
5. He could catch the train.
6. They ought to respect their elders.
7. Would you take a cup of tea?
8. He might not like the movie.
9. He need not trouble you.
10. He dare not oppose me.

10. Interrogative Sentences with Wh-word

Active Voice	Passive Voice
Who has broken the window?	By whom has the window been broken?
What do you want?	What is wanted by you?
Where did you keep your book?	Where was your book kept by you?
Why are you troubling him?	Why is he being troubled by you?
Whom will you inform?	Who will be informed by you?
When did you complete your homework?	When was your homework completed by you?

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. What did you require?
2. Who has painted this picture?
3. When will you return my book?
4. How will you help him?
5. Who will help you?

6. Whom will you invite?
7. Where had you parked your car?
8. Why have you not done your home work?
9. When did you visit Delhi?
10. Whom did you help?

11. Imperative Sentences

Active Voice: Please switch off the fan.

Passive Voice: You are requested to switch off the fan.

Active Voice: Open the door.

Passive Voice: Let the door be opened.

Or

You are ordered to open the door.

Active Voice: Obey your elders.

Passive Voice: You are advised to obey your elders.

Or,

Your elders should be obeyed.

Or,

Let your elders be obeyed.

Active Voice: Don't tell a lie.

Passive Voice: You are advised not to tell a lie. Or, Let a lie not be told. Or, A lie should not be told.

Active Voice: Let her come.

Passive Voice: She should be allowed to come. Or, You are ordered to let her come.

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice

1. Post this letter.
2. Keep your city neat and clean.
3. Don't disturb me.
4. Submit your report by tomorrow.
5. Please bring me a glass of water.
6. Drive your vehicle carefully.
7. Let me accompany you.
8. Sit down.
9. Leave the room at once.
10. Don't tease the dog.

12. Sentences with Prepositional Verbs

A prepositional verb is a verb followed by a preposition. While changing a prepositional verb into passive voice, the preposition must not be dropped.

Active Voice	Passive Voice
He looks after his parents.	His parents are looked after by him.
The children laughed at the beggar.	The beggar was laughed at by the children.
They are cheering up the players.	The players are being cheered up by them.

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. The thief broke into the house
2. He is looking for a new job.....
3. The boss shouted at the peon
4. They were listening to music.....
5. Who is knocking at the door?.....
6. The students peeped into the deserted house
7. They have worked on the project for two months.
8. The British ruled over India for two hundred years.....
9. A speeding train ran over more than sixty people.....
10. Did the CEO preside over the meeting?

13. Sentences with Transitive Verbs with Double Objects

Transitive verbs with double objects can be changed into passive voice by changing either object into subject. However, it is preferable to make indirect object the subject of the passive verb.

Active Voice: She teaches us maths.

Passive Voice: (Direct Object) Maths is taught to us by her.

(Indirect Object) We are taught maths by her.

Active Voice: My father gifted me a watch.

Passive Voice: (Direct Object) A watch was gifted to me by my father.

(Indirect Object) I was gifted a watch by my father

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. My friend lent me some money.....
2. The magistrate asked him a few questions.
3. We will offer her coffee.
4. She gave the beggar a coin.
5. We gave the poor man some bananas.
6. My father gave me a piece of advice.
7. Did your grandmother tell you any story?
8. Has the teacher asked you any questions?
9. He will gift you a bicycle.
10. They presented a memento to the chief guest.

14. Passive Voice of Sentences with Subject Understood

Active Voice: The teacher has corrected my notebook.

Passive Voice: My notebook has been corrected.

Passive Voice: The police have arrested the thief.

Active Voice: The thief has been arrested.

Exercise: Change the following sentences into passive voice.

1. The class teacher made him monitor of the class
2. The parents have named the child Priya.
3. People celebrate Diwali all over India.
4. The Indians call Mahatma Gandhi the father of the nation.
5. The boss has dismissed him.
6. The magistrate has sentenced the murderer to death.
7. The coach made him captain of the school cricket team.
8. The Principal has rusticated the naughty students.
9. The enemy destroyed the whole city.
10. The class teacher marked me absent.